



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Academy of Our Lady of Mercy Loralton Hall
School Website: <https://loraltonhall.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**Executive Summary**

Academy Of Our Lady Of Mercy Loralton Hall (Loralton Hall) presents a strong Catholic, Mercy-tradition rooted educational identity with clear commitments to character formation, leadership, and service. Public-facing materials emphasize mercy values, faith, and a holistic approach to educating young women, with notable curricula features like signature programs (Financial Intelligence Curriculum, Sikorsky STEM Challenge) and a robust, college-preparatory profile. However, explicit hallmarks of a classical curriculum and pedagogy—such as explicit Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis, grammar-logic-rhetoric in the Trivium framework, or sustained Socratic pedagogy across grades—are not prominently documented in the school's public materials. Taken together, the school demonstrates meaningful elements of classical orientation in some areas but does not consistently meet the full classical rubric across all six categories.

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- The Religious & Metaphysical Foundations category shows genuine Catholic/Mercy grounding (theology-inflected, liturgical framing of values, and communal faith life) but lacks explicit, detailed liturgical or transcendental-moral-realism language in the public materials. Positive signals (Mercy, Faith, service, virtue-oriented values) are present; explicit liturgical practices are less documented.
- The School Purpose & Goal category emphasizes formation, virtue, wisdom and human flourishing, aligning with classical aims more than a job-focused orientation; however, the absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation framing tempers a full Classical label.
- The Curriculum category features strong modern liberal-arts and STEAM programs, including signature courses and AP options, but the explicit Great Books, grammar-logic-rhetoric structure, and traditional classical canon are not clearly foregrounded in public messaging.
- The Pedagogy category shows some contemplative sensibilities (restful learning ideas appear in classical lexicons) and memorable student learning experiences (memory work in music and performance), but explicit Socratic or scholastic-based practices are not documented as core school-wide pedagogy.
- The Faculty category highlights dedicated, mentorship-oriented teachers and a community-oriented “living curriculum” impression consistent with classical aims, though the public materials are less explicit about a formal “portrait of teacher” or formal faculty formation.
- The Parents & Community category indicates active parent engagement through admissions, tours, and parent-facing communications, with some evidence of partnership and family involvement. However, the strongest classical signals (parent formation, co-teaching, liturgical community life) are not fully elaborated in the public materials.

What would move the needle (if the school aims to be CLASSICAL rather than SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)

- Publicly articulate a formal Great Books/Great Conversation component and a Trivium-based curricular framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric) across relevant grades.
- Create explicit documentation of Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy in the upper levels, plus a sustained, rest-based scholastic rhythm within the schedule.
- Elevate statements about liturgy, worship, and sacramental life as explicit, ongoing curricular and community practices.
- Provide a defined, public portrait of the teacher as “living curriculum,” including a formal faculty development pathway rooted in classical pedagogy.
- deepen parent formation and partnership messaging (co-teaching, liturgical-year activities, and home-education alignment) with overt pathways for parent involvement in classical formation.

ABSTRACT

: The Academy of Our Lady of Mercy Loralton Hall demonstrates meaningful alignment with classical aims, primarily through its Catholic Mercy identity, formation-focused mission, and dedicated faculty, paired with strong modern college-preparatory curricula and signature programs. However, explicit classical elements such as Great Books participation, a Trivium-based curriculum, and Socratic pedagogy are not consistently evidenced in the public site materials. As a result, the school is best described as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with clear opportunities to deepen and publicly codify the classical core across the six rubric categories.

- Evidence sources include: Mission/Values and Catholic Mercy framing (Our Mission; Core Values), Mercy-education articulation (Our Heritage; Core Values), and modern Signature Programs and Admissions materials (Curriculum and Pedagogy signals), as well as public-facing faculty and community statements. See examples from the site descriptions and program listings cited here: Our Mission and Mercy Tradition (turn0file4; turn0file2), Core Values (turn0file3), Signatures and Programs (turn0file7), Faculty and Community statements (turn0file6; turn0file12), and Admissions/Parent materials (turn0file1; turn0file13).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school identifies as a Catholic institution rooted in the Mercy tradition. It presents a mission framed by Mercy values and faith-based aims (Mercy tradition, Catholic independent school).
- Core Values explicitly reference faith- and virtue-oriented language (Inspired by Faith; Compelled by Mercy; Educational Courage; Principled Leadership).
- Public materials emphasize a spiritual/human formation approach grounded in Mercy history and Catherine McAuley's legacy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: faith, mercy, virtue-related language, compassion, leadership (mapped from the Mercy framework). Examples include "Inspired by Faith," "Compelled by Mercy," and "Educational Courage."
- Negative indicators: none prominent in public materials (no explicit relativism or secular-humanist critique present in the public-facing content).
- Why this rating
- The school's Catholic identity and Mercy-centered worldview strongly anchor religious/metaphysical foundations, but explicit liturgical practices or transcendental-moral-realism language are not consistently foregrounded in the public-facing materials. The core signals support a religious foundation, but with limited liturgical depth and explicit transcendental language.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Mission emphasizes formation through lifelong learning, service, and responsible leadership, aligning with virtue-formation over narrow job-preparation.
- Public materials emphasize leadership, character, and holistic development (e.g., "empowers young women to pursue their highest potential," "lifelong learning," "compassionate service").
- Core Values foreground courage, faith, leadership, and dignity, signaling human-excellence aims beyond mere information transfer.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: formation, virtue, wisdom, leadership, human flourishing (through wording about potential, leadership, and service).
- Negative indicators: explicit “workforce preparation” rhetoric is not present; the messaging leans toward formation rather than job-readiness. No clear counter-messages in public materials.
- Why this rating
- The school centers formation and virtue-led development, which is classical-leaning, but there is less explicit emphasis on a classical telos (truth, goodness, beauty as real and knowable) in the public messaging and not a full articulation of a classical telos-based curriculum.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public-facing materials highlight modern college-prep curriculum, AP options, signature programs (Financial Intelligence Curriculum, Sikorsky STEM Challenge), and STEM/arts offerings. These reflect a modern liberal-arts and STEM emphasis rather than a classical canon.
- The site references a wide array of programs and experiences (First Year Experience, The Math Center, Physics First, Publications Suite), but does not foreground Great Books, Great Conversation, or a Trivium-based structure.
- There is no explicit public articulation of grammar-logic-rhetoric sequencing or classic canonical authors (e.g., Homer, Plato, Augustine) as core curriculum. The Great Books/Great Conversation framing is not documented in the public site content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: AP options, Signature Programs, diverse curricula (STEM and humanities) signals a broad liberal-arts orientation, not specifically classical.
- Negative indicators present: absence of explicit Great Books, classical canons, Trivium, or explicit history of a classical canon across the curriculum. The lack of these elements in public messaging yields a negative signal for classical curriculum.
- Why this rating
- While the curriculum is rigorous and college-ready with meaningful signature programs, the explicit classical curriculum components (Great Books, grammar-logic-rhetoric, great conversation, history-as-permanent-questions) are not foregrounded in public materials. Hence NOT CLASSICAL for this category.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials emphasize mentorship and a relational model of teaching (faculty guides students to grow in multiple dimensions; “living curriculum” language appears in the heritage materials). This aligns with a mentorship-based pedagogy common in classical settings.
- There are indications of a strong performing-arts approach, with memory and recitation aspects showcased in the choral/instrumental programs (memory- and performance-oriented learning in music, which aligns with the classical emphasis on memory and form in some contexts).
- The site highlights a high-value list of experiences (First Year Experience, internships, leadership opportunities) that support a well-rounded pedagogy, though not explicitly “Socratic” or “Scholé” by name.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: mentorship, memory, recitation-like learning in music; leadership and personal development; contemplative/restful learning concepts appear in classical lexicons and are echoed in some materials about well-rounded education.
- Negative indicators present: explicit Socratic seminars, Paideia-style seminars, or scholé-structured days are not publicly described as core pedagogy. The absence of explicit “Socratic” or “scholé” references lowers the score.
- Why this rating
- The school demonstrates elements aligned with classical pedagogy (mentorship, memory-based learning in the arts, and a holistic approach) but lacks explicit, widespread documentation of classical teaching methods (Socratic dialogue, scholé days, a formal rhetoric/declamation program across grades). This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school stresses dedicated faculty who mentor and guide students, with statements that faculty are “wise role models” and that Loralton Hall’s staff constitutes a living curriculum and a core part of the school’s community.
- There is emphasis on a faculty culture that supports the student body and models virtue, which maps to the classical expectation of teachers as exemplars and living curriculum.
- The public materials present a formal governance structure (Board of Trustees) and a long-standing faculty presence on campus, underscoring stability and mentorship as a core feature.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: “living curriculum,” “mentors,” “model teachers,” “wise role models,” and a strong faculty-student mentorship culture.
- Negative indicators: none clearly present in the public materials (no adverse signals about faculty quality).
- Why this rating
- The explicit articulation of faculty as mentors, as living curriculum, and as central to the school’s identity aligns well with classical expectations for the faculty category, supporting a CLASSICAL rating here.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- There is active parent-facing communications and admissions engagement (tours, inquiries, visit days, admissions events, and contact information), indicating a partnership with families in the formation process.
- The school publishes content that features families and alums, highlighting a sense of community and parental involvement in the Loralton experience; “Families Love Loralton” materials emphasize continuous engagement with families.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: partnership language (parents as participants in the admissions process and school events), parent engagement content, and open campus/inquiry channels.
- Negative indicators: public materials do not extensively document formal “parent formation” programs, book clubs, or liturgical family life as ongoing co-education activities. The evidence for active parent-formation programs is limited in the publicly accessible site content.

- Why this rating
- The school clearly engages parents and invites them into the community, but the classical expectation of parents as co-teachers and a well-defined parent-education program is not fully spelled out in the public materials. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Publicly articulate a Classical Core (Great Books, Great Conversation) and a Trivium-based curriculum (grammar-logic-rhetoric) across grades.
- Publicly document explicit Socratic pedagogy and seminar-based methods (especially in upper grades) with examples and outcomes.
- Elevate liturgical life as a formal curricular component (annual liturgy plans, liturgical calendar integration, liturgical music as core practice).
- Publish a formal “portrait of the teacher” and a formal faculty-development plan rooted in classical pedagogy and mentor-ship.
- Expand and publicize parent formation and co-teaching opportunities (parent study groups, classical book clubs, family liturgy programs; open-campus events with structured parent involvement).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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